Ford Motor Company

January 2001

**TO:** All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

**SUBJECT:** **Safety Recall 00S55:** Certain 2000 and 2001 Model Year Focus Vehicles – Left Rear Seat Back Outboard Hinge Replacement

## AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 through 2001 model year 3-door and station wagon Focus vehicles built at the Wayne and Hermosillo Assembly Plants from March 5, 1999 through September 30, 2000.

## SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles, with the left rear seat back in the load carrying position (folded down), the pivot may become disengaged from the hinge if a load is applied to the forward portion of the load floor. If the seat back is then raised without the pivot correctly engaged, the seat and seat belts potentially may not provide the intended performance in the event of a crash.

## SERVICE ACTION

Dealers are directed to replace the left rear seat back outboard hinge with a re-designed hinge. This service must be performed on all affected vehicles.

## PLEASE NOTE

**Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.**

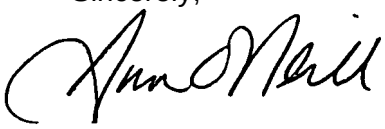
## ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

**QUESTIONS?**

Claims Information:……..……....1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

**Safety Recall 00S55:** Certain 2000 and 2001 Model Year Focus Vehicles – Left Rear Seat Back Outboard Hinge Replacement

## OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

## PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

## DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

## REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

## CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

## OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

## RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not authorized for Safety Recall 00S55.

**Safety Recall 00S55:** Certain 2000 and 2001 Model Year Focus Vehicles – Left Rear Seat Back Outboard Hinge Replacement

## LABOR ALLOWANCES

| Description | Labor Operation | Labor Time |
|---|---|---|
| Replace Left Rear Seat Back Hinge | 00S55B | 0.5 Hours |
| Administrative Allowance | Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN" | 0.1 Hour |

## PARTS REQUIREMENTS

### Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Stock Orders | Effective immediately | Normal order process |
| Interim Orders | Effective immediately | Normal order process |
| Emergency Orders | First 30 days after launch | Call 1-800-325-5621 |
| Emergency Orders | 31 days after launch | Normal order process |

| Description | Part Number | Quantity |
|---|---|---|
| Hinge, Seat Back Pivot | 1S4Z-54613B91-AA | 1 |

## DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

## EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

January 2001

00S55

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 and 2001 model year 3-door and station wagon Focus vehicles built with the 60/40 split rear seat.

**What the safety issue is …**

In some of the affected vehicles, with the left rear seat back in the load carrying position (folded down), the pivot may become disengaged from the hinge if a load is applied to the forward portion of the load floor. If the seat back is then raised without the pivot correctly engaged, the seat and seat belts potentially may not provide the intended performance in the event of a crash.

**What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...**

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for replacement of the left rear seat back outboard hinge.

**How long will it take?**

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

**What we are asking you to do …**

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S55.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

**If you've already paid for this service …**

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

**If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …**

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

**If you have concerns …**

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL:

- (800) 392-3673
- (800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

OFFICE HOURS: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8:00 AM - 11:00 PM
Saturday: 9:00 AM - 6:00 PM

Or you may contact us through the Internet at:
***www.ownerconnection.com***
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 or 1-888-327-4863.

**Quality Care service is there for you all year round.**

QualityCare at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs